

POSITION PAPER

United Nations General Assembly (UNGA)

Delegate: Aftab Laghari | **Country:** Kingdom of Saudi Arabia

Agenda: Strengthening Global Action and International Cooperation to Combat Climate Change

1. Introduction

Climate Change is the biggest global challenge of 21st century. It refers to long-term changes in Earth's average temperature and weather patterns. Though climate change can occur naturally, but currently they're some human made activities that increase Earth's average temperature and cause global warming, such as the burning of fossil fuels, deforestation, and industrial emissions increase greenhouse gases concentrations in the atmosphere. These gases strengthen the natural greenhouse effect therefore global temperatures begin to rise. Climate Change may lead to extreme heat, changing rainfall patterns, melting glaciers, and rising sea levels. Its consequences threaten ecosystem, human health, food security, and water recourses. That's why international cooperation and effective actions are important for this global challenge.

2. Country's Position

The kingdom of Saudi Arabia is positioned on the Frontlines of climate change. The kingdom of Saudi Arabia understands, and takes climate change as a serious global challenge that affects countries and their populations. The kingdom of Saudi Arabia itself faces climate-related challenges, such as rising temperatures, extreme heat, and water scarcity. Our country recognizes that to deal with climate change, we need international cooperation and collective efforts. The kingdom of Saudi Arabia wants to protect its natural resources while promoting economic development and environmental sustainability. Our country recognizes the importance of reducing greenhouse gas emissions and transitioning towards cleaner energy sources. The kingdom of Saudi Arabia is investigating renewable energy specifically in solar and wind energy. Our country also knows the importance of water conservation, desertification control, and environmental protection are important as well. Saudi Arabia believes that climate action should be practical, balanced, and fair, ensuring that environmental protection goes hand in hand with economic development and energy security.

3. Previous Actions

In the past, Saudi Arabia faced serious challenges of water and its climate. The country had very little freshwater recources, so it depended on thermal desalination to produce freshwater. In that old system, about 300,000 barrels of crude oil were burnt every day, that released carbon dioxide (CO_2) into the atmosphere. This increased to greenhouse gas emissions and contributed to global warming. Further, a lot of ancient underground water, known as fossil groundwater. In the outcome, those underground water reserves were rapidly decreasing. To solve those issues, the kingdom of Saudi Arabia took important actions in the past time:

1. **Crop Restriction:** The government restricted those crops which consumed much water.

2. **Solar Reverse-osmosis:** Solar Reverse Osmosis: the kingdom of Saudi Arabia began working on modern reverse osmosis (RO) plants that consume solar energy instead of oil.

3. **Tree-planting Projects:** The country began projects to plant more trees to fight against desertification and help the environment.

4. **Coastal protected areas:** Saudi Arabia took steps to protect marine areas and sea life and arabian gulf from the harmful effects of desalination waste.

4. Proposed Solutions

For solving this global issue, the kingdom of Saudi Arabia would like to recommend these following solutions to the international community.

1. **The use of solar-powered desalination:** For solving this global issue, the kingdom of Saudi Arabia would like to recommend these following solutions to the international community.

2. **The Formula of Circular Carbon Economy (CCE):** Many countries should apply 4Rs formula (Reduce, Reuse, Recycle, and Remove) to capture CO_2 emissions from factories then make clean fuel and fertilizers.

3. **Invest on Green Hydrogen:** As the kingdom of Saudi Arabia is developing world's largest Green Hydrogen plant in NEOM city. The rest of world should invest on this clean fuel that produces water vapour only instead of smoke

4. **Invest in green hydrogen:** Governments and private investors should support research and responsible development of green hydrogen, produced using renewable electricity. International cooperation can help make this emerging low-emission energy option more affordable and accessible.

5. **Recycle wastewater:** The countries where is water scarcity, dirty water of factories and cities should be entirely 100% recycled and used again for plants and industries.